

NovaTech Solutions Pvt. Ltd.

Innovate. Collaborate. Grow.

HR MANUAL, POLICIES & STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURES

Version 1.0 | Effective Date: 1 April 2025

Prepared by: Human Resources Department

Approved by: CEO & Board of Directors

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PART 1 — ABOUT NOVATECH SOLUTIONS

1.1 Company Profile

NovaTech Solutions Pvt. Ltd. is a technology services and software development company incorporated in 2015 under the Companies Act, 2013. Headquartered in Bangalore, NovaTech delivers end-to-end software engineering, cloud transformation, and data analytics solutions to mid-market and enterprise clients across 18 countries.

Incorporated	12 March 2015
CIN	U72900KA2015PTC078432
Registered Office	Plot 42, Tech Park, Whitefield, Bangalore – 560066, Karnataka, India
Industry	Information Technology & Software Services
Employee Strength	~1,200 employees (as of April 2025)
Turnover	INR 480 Crores (FY 2024–25)
Certifications	ISO 9001:2015 ISO 27001:2022 CMMI Level 5
HR Contact	hr@novatechsolutions.in

1.2 Vision, Mission & Core Values

Vision

To be the most trusted technology partner for businesses navigating the digital future.

Mission

We engineer impactful solutions that solve real-world problems — with precision, empathy, and an unwavering commitment to quality.

Core Values

- Integrity — We act with honesty and transparency in every interaction.
- Innovation — We constantly explore better ways to solve problems.
- Collaboration — We succeed together as one team.
- Customer Focus — Client success is our success.
- Excellence — We hold ourselves to the highest professional standards.
- Diversity & Inclusion — We celebrate differences and build equitable workplaces.

1.3 Organisational Structure

NovaTech is led by a CEO supported by a C-Suite comprising the CTO, CFO, CHRO, CMO, and COO. The company operates through five business units:

- Business Unit 1 — Enterprise Software Engineering
- Business Unit 2 — Cloud & DevSecOps
- Business Unit 3 — Data, AI & Analytics
- Business Unit 4 — Digital Experience & UX
- Business Unit 5 — Managed Services & Support

PART 2 — EMPLOYEE HANDBOOK

2.1 Employment Categories

NovaTech employs individuals under the following categories:

Permanent Employee	Full-time, on NovaTech's direct payroll with all benefits
Probationary Employee	New hire on probation (first 6 months of employment)
Fixed-Term Contract	Hired for a defined project or duration (up to 2 years)
Consultant / Freelancer	Engaged via third-party agreement for specialist work
Intern / Trainee	Students or fresh graduates in a structured learning programme

2.2 Probation & Confirmation

All new employees (except laterals at Senior Manager level and above) undergo a 6-month probationary period. During probation:

- Performance is reviewed at the end of Month 3 and Month 6.
- The probation period may be extended by up to 3 months if performance is below expectation.
- Employment may be terminated during probation with 2 weeks' notice from either party.

Upon successful completion, the employee receives a written Confirmation Letter from HR.

2.3 Working Hours & Attendance

- Standard working hours: 9 hours per day including a 1-hour lunch break (net 8 hours).
- Core hours: 10:00 AM – 5:00 PM IST. Flexible start between 8:00 AM and 10:30 AM.
- Work-from-home (WFH): Up to 2 days per week for eligible roles (as designated by the Department Head).
- Attendance is tracked via biometric / HRMS login. Unplanned absences must be reported by 9:30 AM to the reporting manager.
- Three or more consecutive unexplained absences constitute abandonment of employment and may lead to termination.

2.4 Dress Code & Workplace Conduct

NovaTech maintains a business-casual dress code on all office days. Formal business attire is required when meeting clients.

Employees are expected to:

- Treat all colleagues, clients, and vendors with respect and professionalism.
- Maintain a clean, safe, and organised workspace.
- Avoid disruptive behaviour including offensive language or conduct.
- Respect confidentiality of company and client information at all times.

2.5 Compensation & Benefits

Salary Structure

Basic Salary	40% of Cost to Company (CTC)
HRA	50% of Basic for metro / 40% of Basic for non-metro locations
Conveyance Allowance	INR 1,600 per month
Medical Allowance	INR 1,250 per month
Special Allowance	Balance of CTC after all statutory deductions
Performance Bonus	Up to 15% of annual CTC, paid annually in April
PF (Employee)	12% of Basic, deducted monthly and remitted to EPFO
Gratuity	As per Payment of Gratuity Act, 1972

Additional Benefits

- Group Health Insurance: INR 5 Lakhs family floater (employee + spouse + 2 children + parents)
- Group Term Life Insurance: 3× Annual CTC
- Group Personal Accident Cover: 5× Annual CTC
- Employee Assistance Programme (EAP): Free, confidential counselling (6 sessions/year)
- Education Assistance: Up to INR 50,000 per year for approved courses
- Meal Card: INR 2,200 per month, tax-exempt under Section 17(2)
- NovaTech Employee Stock Option Plan (ESOP): Available to Senior Manager & above

PART 3 — HR POLICIES

3.1 Leave Policy

NovaTech Leave Policy			
Version	Effective Date	Policy Owner	Scope
v1.0	1 April 2025	Head – HR	All Employees

3.1.1 Purpose

To define entitlements, procedures, and responsibilities related to employee leaves, ensuring operational continuity while providing adequate rest and personal time.

3.1.2 Leave Entitlements

Leave Type	Days/Year	Carry Forward	Encashable	Applicable To
Earned Leave (EL)	18 days	Yes (up to 30)	Yes	All employees
Casual Leave (CL)	12 days	No	No	All employees
Sick Leave (SL)	10 days	No (up to 3)	No	All employees
Maternity Leave	182 days	N/A	No	Female employees
Paternity Leave	5 days	N/A	No	Male employees
Bereavement Leave	3 days	N/A	No	All employees
Comp Off	As earned	Yes (3 months)	No	All employees
Study Leave	Up to 10 days	No	No	After 2 yrs service

3.1.3 Leave Application Rules

- All leave requests must be submitted through the HRMS portal (portal.novatech.in) before the commencement of leave, except in emergencies.
- Earned Leave requires a minimum of 3 working days' advance notice.
- Leave approval rests with the immediate Reporting Manager and is subject to project/team requirements.
- Leaves taken without approval are treated as Loss of Pay (LOP).
- Employees may not combine more than 30 days of EL into a single continuous leave period without written HR approval.
- The company's leave year runs from 1 April to 31 March.

3.1.4 Public Holidays

NovaTech observes 10 mandatory national/state public holidays and offers 6 optional restricted holidays (employees may choose from an HR-published list). Restricted holidays not availed during the year are forfeited.

3.2 Code of Conduct Policy

NovaTech Code of Conduct Policy			
Version	Effective Date	Policy Owner	Scope
v1.0	1 April 2025	Head – HR & Legal	All Employees, Contractors, Interns

3.2.1 Purpose

This policy establishes the behavioural standards expected of every NovaTech associate. It protects the reputation of the company, the safety of its employees, and the interests of its clients.

3.2.2 General Conduct

- Employees shall conduct themselves professionally at all times.
- Consumption of alcohol or controlled substances during office hours or on company premises is strictly prohibited.
- Personal romantic relationships between a direct reporting manager and a subordinate must be disclosed to HR.
- Social media posts that identify NovaTech clients, projects, or internal financials without prior PR/Legal approval are prohibited.

3.2.3 Conflict of Interest

- Employees must disclose any external employment, directorship, or financial interest that may conflict with NovaTech's interests.
- Accepting gifts, hospitality, or payments from vendors/clients exceeding INR 2,000 in value must be disclosed and approved by the Ethics Committee.

3.2.4 Disciplinary Framework

Level 1 — Verbal Warning	Minor infractions: repeated tardiness, informal dress code breach, minor insubordination
Level 2 — Written Warning	Repeated Level 1 offences; unauthorised absence; misuse of company assets
Level 3 — Final Warning / PIP	Gross negligence; disclosure of confidential information; harassment

Level 4 — Suspension	Pending inquiry for serious misconduct
Level 5 — Termination	Fraud, theft, violence, proven sexual harassment, willful damage to company property

3.3 Prevention of Sexual Harassment (POSH) Policy

POSH Policy — The Sexual Harassment of Women at Workplace Act, 2013			
Version	Effective Date	Policy Owner	Scope
v1.0	1 April 2025	POSH Committee / CHRO	All Employees & Visitors

3.3.1 Zero-Tolerance Commitment

NovaTech is committed to a safe, respectful, and harassment-free workplace. Sexual harassment in any form — verbal, non-verbal, physical, or digital — is strictly prohibited and will result in disciplinary action, up to and including termination and criminal prosecution.

3.3.2 Internal Complaints Committee (ICC)

Presiding Officer	Senior female employee at or above VP level
Members	2 employees committed to women's welfare
External Member	NGO representative with expertise in gender issues
Complaint Deadline	Within 3 months of the last incident
Inquiry Timeline	Completed within 60 days of complaint receipt
Appeals	Within 90 days of inquiry completion to District Officer

3.3.3 Reporting a Complaint

1. The complainant submits a written complaint to the ICC Presiding Officer or any ICC member.
2. The ICC acknowledges receipt within 7 working days.
3. Conciliation may be offered (not for monetary settlement).
4. If conciliation fails or is not sought, a formal inquiry commences.
5. The inquiry report and recommendations are submitted to the MD/CEO within 10 days of completion.
6. Action is taken by the company within 60 days of receiving ICC recommendations.

3.4 Performance Management Policy

Performance Management Policy			
Version	Effective Date	Policy Owner	Scope
v1.0	1 April 2025	Head – HR & Business Units	All Permanent Employees

3.4.1 Performance Cycle

NovaTech follows an annual performance cycle (April – March) with a structured mid-year review in October.

Goal Setting	April 1 – April 30 each year
Mid-Year Review	October 1 – October 31
Year-End Review (Self)	March 1 – March 15
Manager Assessment	March 16 – March 31
Calibration & Ratings	April 1 – April 15
Increment & Promotion Letters	Issued by April 30

3.4.2 Rating Scale

Rating	Description	Merit Increment Range
5 – Exceptional	Significantly exceeds all goals; demonstrates leadership beyond role	15–20%
4 – Exceeds Expectations	Consistently exceeds most goals with high quality	10–14%
3 – Meets Expectations	Meets all goals; performs role effectively	5–9%
2 – Needs Improvement	Partially meets goals; requires a Performance Improvement Plan	0–4%
1 – Unsatisfactory	Does not meet goals; immediate action plan required	0%

3.4.3 Performance Improvement Plan (PIP)

- Employees rated 2 (Needs Improvement) for two consecutive quarters are placed on a formal 90-day PIP.
- The PIP defines specific, measurable goals with bi-weekly check-ins.
- Failure to meet PIP targets may result in termination, role change, or extended PIP at manager's discretion.

3.5 IT Assets & Data Security Policy

IT Assets & Data Security Policy			
Version	Effective Date	Policy Owner	Scope
v1.0	1 April 2025	Head – IT & CISO	All Employees & Contractors

3.5.1 Acceptable Use

- Company-issued devices (laptops, mobile phones, access cards) are for business use. Incidental personal use is permitted provided it does not interfere with work.
- Installation of unlicensed software is prohibited. All software must be approved via an IT request ticket.
- Employees must lock screens when stepping away and must not share passwords or access credentials.

3.5.2 Data Classification

Public	Marketing material, published press releases — no restrictions
Internal	Internal memos, org charts — share within NovaTech only
Confidential	Client data, source code, financials — need-to-know basis, encrypted in transit
Restricted	Personal data (DPDPA), trade secrets — strict access controls, encrypted at rest

3.5.3 Incident Reporting

Any actual or suspected data breach must be reported to the CISO (security@novatechsolutions.in) within 1 hour of discovery. Employees who conceal incidents face disciplinary action. NovaTech complies with CERT-In's 6-hour incident reporting mandate.

PART 4 — STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURES (SOPs)

SOP 4.1 Recruitment & Selection

SOP: Recruitment & Selection			
Version	Effective Date	Policy Owner	Scope
v1.0	1 April 2025	HR – Talent Acquisition	Hiring Managers, HR BPs

4.1.1 Purpose & Scope

This SOP governs the end-to-end recruitment process at NovaTech — from identifying a vacancy to onboarding the selected candidate — ensuring a fair, consistent, and legally compliant hiring experience.

4.1.2 Recruitment Workflow

Step	Action / Description	Responsible	Timeline
1	Hiring Manager raises a Manpower Requisition Form (MRF) in HRMS, attaches Job Description (JD)	Hiring Manager	Day 1
2	HR BP reviews MRF; approves headcount against budgeted positions	HR Business Partner	Day 1–2
3	CHRO / Finance sign-off for roles above INR 15 LPA CTC	CHRO / CFO	Day 2–3
4	Talent Acquisition (TA) posts role on internal portal (internal first for 5 days), then external (Naukri, LinkedIn, Referral Programme)	TA Team	Day 3–5
5	TA screens applications; shortlists CVs using JD checklist	TA Recruiter	Day 5–10
6	Shortlisted candidates undergo HR Telephonic Screening (culture fit, notice period, salary expectations)	TA Recruiter	Day 10–14
7	Technical interview (1–2 rounds) with Hiring Manager / Tech Panel	Hiring Manager / Panel	Day 14–20
8	HR interview (competency-based) for final shortlisted candidate(s)	HR BP	Day 20–22
9	Reference check (2 professional references, minimum last direct manager)	TA / BGV Vendor	Day 22–25
10	Verbal offer extended; negotiations completed; formal Offer Letter issued via DocuSign	TA / Compensation Team	Day 25–28
11	Candidate accepts offer; pre-boarding checklist initiated (document collection, IT provisioning)	TA + IT + Admin	Post-acceptance
12	Day 1 Onboarding — joining formalities, system access, induction schedule	HR + Buddy	Day of joining

4.1.3 Background Verification

- BGV is mandatory for all permanent employees before confirmation.
- Checks include: Identity, Address, Education (last qualifying degree), Employment (last 7 years), Criminal record, Credit (for finance/senior roles).
- BGV is conducted by the empanelled vendor within 15 working days of joining.
- Adverse BGV findings are reviewed by the CHRO and may result in offer rescission or termination during probation.

SOP 4.2 Employee Onboarding

SOP: New Employee Onboarding			
Version	Effective Date	Policy Owner	Scope
v1.0	1 April 2025	HR Operations	All New Joiners & Buddy Managers

4.2.1 Pre-Joining Checklist

- Offer letter, appointment letter, and NDA sent via DocuSign at least 7 days before DOJ.
- Welcome email with first-day agenda, parking information, and dress code sent 3 days before DOJ.
- IT Team provisions: laptop, email ID, HRMS access, VPN credentials, project tool logins.
- Admin Team arranges workstation, access card, and visitor badge.

4.2.2 Day 1 – Joining Formalities

Step	Action / Description	Responsible	Timeline
1	Collect original documents: Photo ID, PAN Card, Aadhaar, degree certificates, last 3 months' payslips, resignation acceptance letter	HR Operations	9:00 – 10:00 AM
2	Complete joining kit forms: Form 11 (PF), ESI declaration, bank account details, family declaration	HR Operations	10:00 – 11:00 AM
3	Issue company assets: Laptop, access card, mobile SIM (if applicable). Sign Asset Acknowledgement Form	IT + Admin	11:00 – 11:30 AM
4	Infrastructure and systems walkthrough: Email, HRMS, Slack, Jira, Git, VPN setup	IT Buddy	11:30 AM – 1:00 PM
5	Welcome lunch with immediate team and Buddy	Buddy Manager	1:00 – 2:00 PM
6	Introduction to BU Head; overview of team goals, current sprint/project	BU Head / Manager	2:00 – 3:00 PM
7	Complete mandatory e-learning modules: POSH, Information Security, Code of Conduct, and Workplace Safety	New Joiner	3:00 – 5:00 PM

4.2.3 Week 1 – Structured Induction

- Day 2: Deep dive into BU strategy, product/service portfolio, key clients, and OKRs with BU Head.
- Day 3: Finance & Legal — payroll, expense claims, IP ownership, confidentiality obligations.
- Day 4: Technology Architecture overview with CTO's office (for tech roles) / Domain onboarding (for non-tech roles).
- Day 5: NovaTech Culture, DEI initiatives, CSR programmes, and Employee Resource Groups (ERGs).

SOP 4.3 Employee Offboarding & Exit

SOP: Employee Exit & Offboarding			
Version	Effective Date	Policy Owner	Scope
v1.0	1 April 2025	HR Operations	All Separating Employees

4.3.1 Notice Period Requirements

Associate / Senior Associate	30 days
Consultant / Senior Consultant	45 days
Manager / Senior Manager	60 days
Associate Director & above	90 days
C-Suite / VP & above	120 days

4.3.2 Exit Process Workflow

Step	Action / Description	Responsible	Timeline
1	Employee submits resignation via HRMS or written email to Reporting Manager and HR	Employee	Day 1 (of notice period)
2	Reporting Manager acknowledges and accepts resignation in HRMS within 2 working days	Reporting Manager	Day 1–3
3	HR generates Exit Clearance Checklist in HRMS and mails it to employee	HR Operations	Day 3
4	Knowledge Transfer (KT) plan agreed between employee and manager; documented in HRMS	Employee + Manager	Day 3–7
5	IT decommissioning plan prepared: revoke access on last working day (LWD) at EOD	IT Security	LWD
6	Employee returns all assets: Laptop, access card, mobile SIM, documents. Asset Return Form signed	Admin + IT	LWD

7	HR conducts confidential Exit Interview (30 min) — results logged for retention analytics	HR BP	2 days before LWD
8	Full & Final (F&F) settlement calculated: pending salary, EL encashment, gratuity (if eligible), bonus pro-rata	Payroll Team	Within 45 days of LWD
9	Experience letter and relieving letter issued after clearance from all departments	HR Operations	Within 45 days of LWD
10	Alumni portal access provided; employee added to NovaTech Alumni Network (optional)	HR Operations	With exit documents

SOP 4.4 Business Expense Reimbursement

SOP: Business Expense Reimbursement			
Version	Effective Date	Policy Owner	Scope
v1.0	1 April 2025	Finance & HR	All Employees

4.4.1 Eligible Expense Categories

Travel — Air	Economy class for domestic; Business class for flights > 6 hours
Travel — Rail/Bus	AC First / AC 2-Tier for rail; AC bus for road travel
Local Conveyance	Actuals (cab/auto); personal vehicle at INR 8/km
Hotels	Up to INR 4,000/night for Tier-1 cities; INR 2,500 for Tier-2/3
Meals (per diem)	INR 600/day domestic; INR 1,500/day international
Client Entertainment	Up to INR 5,000 with prior Manager approval
Mobile Roaming	Actuals up to INR 1,000/day international; domestic: company SIM provided
Visa/Travel Insurance	Actuals for international business travel

4.4.2 Reimbursement Workflow

Step	Action / Description	Responsible	Timeline
1	Employee submits expense report in SAP Concur / HRMS within 30 days of incurring expense; attaches all receipts (originals or scanned)	Employee	Within 30 days
2	Manager reviews and approves expense report in HRMS within 5 working days	Reporting Manager	Day 1–5
3	Finance Accounts Payable (AP) team audits claims for policy compliance and completeness	Finance AP	Day 5–8
4	Finance AP flags exceptions or seeks clarification from employee; employee responds within 3 days	Finance AP / Employee	As needed
5	Approved expenses are processed in the next payroll cycle or as an off-cycle payment if > INR 10,000	Payroll	Within 15 days of approval

6	Payment credited to employee's salary account with itemised breakup	Payroll	Per schedule
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SOP 4.5 Employee Grievance Redressal

SOP: Grievance Redressal			
Version	Effective Date	Policy Owner	Scope
v1.0	1 April 2025	HR Business Partners	All Employees

4.5.1 Guiding Principles

- Every employee has the right to raise a grievance without fear of retaliation.
- All grievances are treated with confidentiality and dignity.
- Resolutions are sought at the lowest possible escalation level.
- Frivolous or malicious complaints will be dealt with under the Code of Conduct Policy.

4.5.2 Grievance Escalation Matrix

Level 1 (Informal)	Discussion between employee and Reporting Manager within 5 working days
Level 2	If unresolved, escalated to HR Business Partner within 7 working days
Level 3	HR BP convenes a formal hearing with all parties; resolution in 15 working days
Level 4	Unresolved matters referred to CHRO and, if needed, an independent mediator
Level 5 (External)	Recourse to Labour Commissioner / appropriate legal forum

4.5.3 Grievance Workflow

Step	Action / Description	Responsible	Timeline
1	Employee raises grievance verbally or via email to Reporting Manager or HR	Employee	Day 0
2	HR logs grievance in the confidential Grievance Register with unique case ID	HR BP	Day 1
3	Acknowledgement sent to employee confirming receipt and expected timeline	HR BP	Day 1
4	HR conducts preliminary inquiry; speaks with relevant parties	HR BP	Day 2–7
5	HR proposes resolution; discusses with employee and relevant stakeholders	HR BP	Day 7–12

6	Final resolution communicated in writing to employee	HR BP / CHRO	Day 12–15
7	Follow-up with employee after 30 days to confirm resolution holds	HR BP	Day 45
8	Case closed and logged; trends reported quarterly to CHRO	HR Ops	Quarterly

PART 5 — EMPLOYEE ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

I, the undersigned, confirm that I have received, read, and understood the NovaTech Solutions Pvt. Ltd. HR Manual, Policies, and Standard Operating Procedures (Version 1.0, effective 1 April 2025).

I agree to comply with all policies and procedures contained herein, and understand that failure to do so may result in disciplinary action. I acknowledge that NovaTech may update, revise, or rescind any policy with reasonable notice, and that the most current version is always available on the HRMS portal.

Employee Full Name	
Employee ID	
Designation	
Department / BU	
Date of Joining	
Signature	
Date	